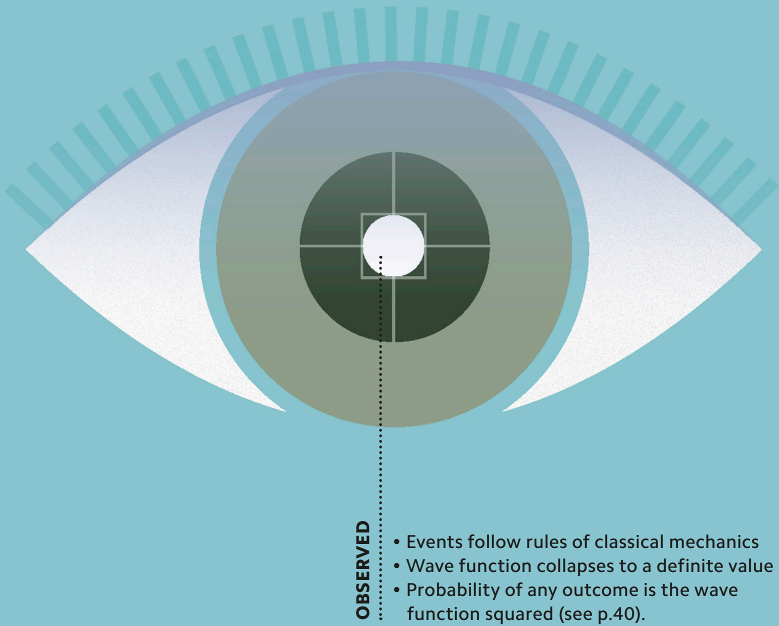

UNDERSTANDING QUANTUM PHYSICS

The Copenhagen interpretation was the earliest attempt to bridge the gap between the quantum world and classical physics. In this view, the act of an observer measuring the state of a quantum system causes it to resolve instantaneously to a single value—a phenomenon called the collapse of the wave function (see p.48). The wave equation itself is treated as merely offering a measure of the probability that different values will be detected when the observation takes place (see pp.36–37).